Estimation

Size work together quickly with planning poker, T-shirt sizes or affinity estimation, or decide not to estimate.

Iterate · Planning Poker · T-Shirt Sizing · Affinity Estimation · Relative, Not Absolute

TEAM _____

DATE _____

1 Planning Poker

FOR A HANDFUL OF ITEMS

1	2	3	5	8	13	20	?	☕

1. Read the item
2. Pick a card privately
3. Reveal together
4. Highest and lowest explain
5. Re-vote, two rounds at most

ITEM	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ESTIMATE

2 T-Shirt Sizing

FOR MANY ITEMS, ROUGHLY

XS	S	M	L	XL
Items	*Items*	*Items*	*Items*	*Items*

Reference item that is an “M”: _____

3 Affinity Estimation

FOR A WHOLE BACKLOG IN AN HOUR

- Silently place items left to right, smallest to largest. Anyone can move any item.
- Then discuss items that keep moving, and draw size boundaries.

Items, smallest on the left

SMALLER → LARGER

1 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 13

4 Reference Items

SHARED EXAMPLES KEEP SIZES CONSISTENT

SIZE	ITEM EVERYONE REMEMBERS	WHY THIS SIZE

5 Or Don't Estimate

COUNTING ITEMS OFTEN FORECASTS JUST AS WELL

- If items are split small enough to finish within your SLE, count them instead of sizing them.
- Forecast from throughput with the Release Forecast board.

☐ We'll try counting items instead of estimating for _____ iterations, then compare

6 Ground Rules

- ☐ Estimates belong to the people doing the work
- ☐ An estimate is a forecast, not a promise
- ☐ Never compare points between teams

“Is this bigger or smaller than the last thing we finished?”

“Do we need a number, or do we just need to know it's small?”

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